

Brand Profile & Recommendations

Executive Summary - Short

Quick, high-credibility intro. Good for LinkedIn, conference program bios, top of pitch decks, on press releases, etc.

Alpha Funds is a venture capital firm focused on space and deep tech, the industries building the future of Earth, off Earth. Alpha Funds takes lead positions in companies, raises around them, and brings the operational support founders need to scale.

Members of the team have crossed the Kármán Line, built national military space programs, managed risk at major financial institutions, and worked closely with every layer of the space sector for more than a decade. The guiding viewpoint is space and deep tech is the defining investment frontier of our time, and the companies getting there first will define the future.

Executive Summary - Long

Longer, in-depth intro. Good for formal introductions, context before meetings, an "About Us" page on the website, appendix or background in a proposal.

Alpha Funds is a venture capital firm focused on space and deep tech, the industries building the future of Earth, off Earth.

Alpha Funds takes lead positions in companies, raises around them, and brings the operational support founders need to scale. The firm operates across a growing portfolio of funds with distinct strategies. The guiding viewpoint is space and deep tech is the defining investment frontier of our time, and the companies getting there first will define the future.

The sector's trajectory confirms this. The global space economy is projected to reach \$1.8 trillion by 2035 according to McKinsey & Company, nearly tripling from its 2023 value of \$630 billion. Alpha Funds exists to back the companies driving that growth.

Founded by J.D. Russell, a twice-flown Blue Origin astronaut and serial entrepreneur, Alpha Funds brings firsthand experience in space to venture capital. The firm pairs deep space expertise with experienced financial professionals in investment management and risk, ensuring that conviction in the sector is matched by disciplined capital allocation. Members of the team have crossed the Kármán Line, built national military space programs, and worked in the sector for more than a decade. Those relationships inform how Alpha Funds evaluates where the space economy is heading, which founders can get there, and which technologies will matter.

Brand Story

Emotional pull. "Our Story" page on website. Keynote or fireside chat script/guide, ways to connect people with the mission, place where we share the bigger why.

Space touches nearly everything in modern life - the wifi in your home. the GPS in your pocket. the content streaming your tv, your water filtration device. These were all originally developed for space exploration, and now part of daily life.

Every major industry on Earth has a parallel new industry being built in space right now. We look at the future of Manufacturing, Medicine, Energy, Computing, Robotics, and Agriculture. Cancer cells can grow significantly faster in microgravity, compressing research timelines that would take much longer on Earth. Data centers in orbit eliminate the environmental strain of cooling them on Earth. Stem cells can be grown stronger in microgravity before being used for someone back home.

According to McKinsey & Company, the global space economy is projected to reach \$1.8 trillion by 2035, nearly tripling from its 2023 value of \$630 billion.

The companies building the space economy need investors who are embedded from the inside. Space professionals who understand the policy, strategies and demand signal of government and industry alike. Those who have built national military space programs, and led risk management programs. Investors who are talking to the scientists, engineers, system operators, procurement specialists and researchers. Investors who can recognize talent early and put the appropriate support around them to help those founders succeed. This is why Alpha Funds exists.

We were founded by J.D. Russell, serial Entrepreneur and twice flown commercial astronaut, after he had the life-altering experience of going to space. He went to space because he was curious, and didn't expect it to change his life. But when you're floating above the Earth and you see the whole planet, fragile, finite, and beautiful, something shifts. Astronauts call this experience the Overview Effect.

J.D. came back seeing the world differently. He saw that when we build industry off planet, we protect the one we live on and secure the future opportunities for generations to come. Alpha Funds backs the companies and founders most equipped to turn today's science fiction into tomorrow's expectation .

Space is infinite. Earth is not.

We invest for Earth's future.

Mission

We support the companies building humanity's future in space and deep tech.

Our Why

We believe the technologies built for space will transform life on Earth, and the right capital, deployed early, enables that future.

Vision

Make life on earth better, cleaner, healthier, and more efficient through investing in the next horizon.

Unique Standing

We know space because we're in every layer of it, from military and civil program development to commercial partnerships to actually crossing the Kármán Line.

Tagline Options

- We invest for Earth's future.
- Invest where the future is.
- Where the future is built.
- Invest in tomorrow's future today.
- **Investing at the edge.**
- **Today's science fiction. Tomorrow's expectation.**

Commonly Used Phrases

- Invest where the future is.
- We invest for Earth's future.
- Space is infinite. Earth is not.
- Every major industry on Earth has a parallel new industry being built in space right now.
- We invest for our planet. We invest for our future.
- Invest in a future that's better for everyone.
- Invest in space for Earth
 - Build in space for Earth
- Help grow the industries that cultivate these opportunities.
- Seize the opportunity, change the world.
- Change the world, have fun.
- Helping build humanity's next era.

Tone

- Confident, Passionate, Warm, Example-backed, Demystifying (explaining with firm facts/examples), Proud, Real, Strong
- Grounding big ideas in concrete examples (ex: Velcro, not "unprecedented innovation", GPS, not "transformative technology, etc.)

- Plain language. Short words over long ones. (ex. “Back”, over “capitalize”, “build” over “construct,” “Find” over “identify.”)
- Occasional Irreverence. “Build the damn thing.” “Hell yeah.” “I got a face for radio.” All direct quotes from J.D. The brand, while still being professional, forward facing, can also be warm, and occasionally irreverent.

Fun Claude Analysis: If Alpha Funds were a person at a dinner party, they'd be the one who quietly mentions they've been to space, then spends the next 20 minutes explaining — with real enthusiasm — why orbital computing is going to change everything. They'd use concrete examples. They'd pull you in with “think about it” and “here's how it actually works.” And they'd make you believe it — not because they oversold it, but because they clearly believe it themselves.

What the Tone is Not

Performative, Boastful, Inauthentic, Fluffy, Overly Emotional

What Drives Us

Helping build humanity's next era.

Change the world, have fun doing it.

We invest early. We invest where the future is heading, not where the crowd already is.

Founders first. Great ideas are everywhere. What's rare is the person willing to build the damn thing. We back those people and help fill the gaps.

First hand experience. You can get a good look at a rocket by watching it go by. But if you've been inside one or built one yourself, you see things differently. We work with the rocket scientists, propulsion engineers, and defense leaders for inside perspective on what's emerging.

Early advantage. The market underestimates space, carrying legacy assumptions about capital intensity and long timelines. In reality, the sector is fragmenting into capital-efficient layers where early investors can capture outsized ownership in companies that become critical infrastructure. For much of the space economy, that early moment is now.

Our Portfolio

Alpha Funds backs founders in space and deep tech who are first to market or built to disrupt.

Anthropic — AI safety and research

BioOrbit — Space-based biological research

Boom Technologies — Supersonic commercial aviation

Dawn Aerospace — Reusable spaceplanes and green satellite propulsion

Gravitics — Space station modules and orbital habitats

OpenAI — Artificial intelligence

Palm Republic — Premium spirits
Sophia Space — Space-based edge computing and orbital data centers
Starpath — Lunar robotics and space resource exploration
Stathera — Timing semiconductors (deep tech)
XSET (?)

Team

J.D. Russell — Founder & CEO

J.D. Russell is an entrepreneur known for acquiring and scaling companies into nationally recognized market leaders. After putting himself through college while serving as a police officer, he transitioned into business, quickly earning a reputation for identifying underserved industries and transforming operational inefficiencies into growth opportunities. He founded a community management firm that scaled rapidly through a strategic blend of organic expansion, targeted acquisitions, and technology driven operational efficiencies. Russell's success is fueled by a rare combination of operational precision and visionary leadership while identifying potential, building scale, and executing with discipline.

In November of 2024, he made history as the first retired (LEOSA) American police officer to travel to space, becoming the 670th person to cross the Kármán Line aboard Blue Origin's New Shepard 9th human mission ([NS-28](#)), and history again as one of nine private astronauts to make two trips over the Kármán Line in August 2025 on the fourteenth human mission ([NS-34](#)). J.D. consequently earned his [commercial astronaut wings](#) with Blue Origin. He also serves on the Board of Directors of Space for Humanity, a non-profit dedicated to democratizing access to space.

He founded the [Victoria Russell Foundation](#) in memory of his daughter. The foundation is a proud partner of the Dolly Parton Foundation.

Austin Litteral – COO

Austin Litteral is known for bringing ideas to life and scaling business operations for founders. His experience managing and consulting for small businesses through growth stages propelled him into a career in financial services. Austin joined JPMorganChase following the completion of his MBA. During his time at the firm, Austin had a number of opportunities and most recently served in a director level position in Risk Management. His career has been a journey through various industries and functions leading to his drive for operational excellence and vision for solving even the most complex business. He had the opportunity to travel to space when he launched aboard Blue Origin's 9th human space flight in November of 2024.

Ben Till – Director, Space Operations and Deep Tech Investments

Ben Till joins Alpha Funds following more than two decades in the New Zealand Defence Force spanning aviation, defense, and space capability leadership. A former Navy and Air Force pilot

with thousands of flight hours across weapon, sensor and transport platforms including rotary and fixed wing aircraft. Ben has operated globally from land and embarked aboard aircraft carriers, frigates and destroyers from three navies in support of multinational activities across UN, NATO, and Five Power Defence Agreement frameworks. He holds a Master of Defence Studies from King's College London focused on security in space and the challenges of emerging technologies, served as the first joint space planner and then Director Space Programme for the New Zealand Defence Force. Most recently he served in a diplomatic engagement role as New Zealand's Air Attaché (covering space) to the United States. At Alpha Funds, Ben contributes operational insight, a global defense aerospace network, and strategic perspective to investment sourcing, diligence, and portfolio growth.

Rachel Lyons – Investor Relations

Rachel Lyons advises founders and executives in space and frontier technology on leadership, brand, and communications. She is also dedicated to the development of women in leadership. She brings more than a decade of experience at the intersection of space exploration and leadership development, supporting leaders in bringing bold visions from idea to reality.

Rachel was the first full-time employee and Executive Director of Space for Humanity, where she led the organization to become the first nonprofit in history to send civilians to space. Under her leadership, four individuals flew to space and the organization's work reached global audiences in the hundreds of millions. She has spoken at more than 100 events globally and has been featured in CNN, NPR, PBS, ABC News, VICE, Business Insider, and USA Today. She holds a B.S. in Aerospace Engineering and Economics.

Audiences

In order of priority

1. **LPs, Family Offices, Institutional Investors.** Engaged through private, controlled channels for compliance. We present as trustworthy, passionate partners with deep expertise from the inside of the space sector. They may not be involved with space already, so skilled communication + presentation is important.
2. **Co-investing VCs.** Other venture capital firms and family offices that want to co-invest alongside Alpha Funds. Collaborative allyship, not competition.
3. **Founders seeking investment.** Companies in space and deep tech. "98 out of 100 we say no to." But the website should still invite contact.

Website Goals

1. **Credibility.** Create trust in who we are, our experience, our vision.
2. **Investor interest.** Make the right people want to reach out via a general contact form, without solicitation.
3. **Co-investor attraction.** Other VCs and family offices should see Alpha Funds as a credible lead they'd want to partner with.

4. **Deal flow.** Founders in space and deep tech should be able to find the site, understand what Alpha Funds backs, and submit a pitch or get in touch.

What visitors should feel. Our passion. Credibility. Trust. Inspiration + Excitement. Awe.

What should be avoided. Boasting or bragging. Too much quantitative information (risk of being wrong is a liability)

Social Media Strategy

Linkedin

Goal: Build credibility of our expertise + unique standing, attract interest from LP + co-investors, never solicit.

Types of posts: Portfolio company wins, shares from team members experiences, whats going on in space, shares about tech that we're invested in (could be a WHY, or specific to portfolio companies)

Content Rotation:

1. **Sector Insight:** "Why this matters" to demystify space and deep tech for people outside the industry, or to ignite passion for those inside it.
2. **Founder Spotlight:** Short posts about why the person in this company is doing well, why they are a genius, etc.
3. **Quick Mention of Company:**
4. **Behind the lens:** J.D. + teams experiences, perspectives, the overview effect, etc. This could be shared from team members pages, as personal pages do better on linkedin than companies. Note for events, post a learning, or why it was important to be there.

Cadence: 2-3 posts per week. J.D. + team posting once/week or more is great too.

What not to do: No "invest with us" language. Only goal is to build awareness and trust.

Instagram - Phase 2

Facebook - Phase 2

Logo

Drafts

0.



ALPHA FUNDS



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Some other options:



Regulations + Compliance

Note: This was analyzed and summarized in human speak by Claude. There could be errors.

Regulatory Quick Reference — 506(b)

Review with legal counsel before publishing any materials.

The rule: No general solicitation or advertising. The public brand builds credibility and awareness. It does not sell or solicit.

Public channels (website, LinkedIn, press) — OK: Who we are. Team backgrounds. Focus areas. Thought leadership. Portfolio company names. General contact form.

Public channels — NOT OK: Fund terms. Offering details. Returns or projections. "Invest with us." "We're raising." Any quantitative performance claims.

Fund-specific content lives behind a password-protected portal only. Log who receives what, when, and through what channel.

Before posting anything, ask: "Could someone read this as an invitation to invest?" If yes, it can't be public.

Recommended website footer disclaimer: "Alpha Funds Management LLC provides this website and its contents for informational purposes only. Nothing on this site constitutes an offer to sell, a solicitation of an offer to buy, or a recommendation for any security or investment product. Past performance is not indicative of future results. All investments involve risk, including possible loss of principal."

Final disclaimer language to be approved by legal counsel.

WHAT'S NEXT

This brand guide is the strategic foundation. The following deliverables build on it:

Brand Style Guide — Visual identity system (color, typography, logo usage, photography direction, iconography).

Website Design & Build — Informed by the messaging architecture, audience priorities, tone, and compliance framework established here. Structured to deliver credibility first, then invite relationship — never to solicit. Password-protected investor portal to be designed separately for fund-specific content.

Website Animations Design & Build — Create animations for the website, hire developer to go live.

LinkedIn Content Guide — How to post, what to say, content pillars, cadence, and voice for social channels — with clear guardrails for compliant public posting.

Logo — Informed by J.D.'s direction and discussion in team meeting: rocket feel without literal modern rocket imagery, nod to the Blue Origin astronaut pin aesthetic, Space Force/Air Force energy without direct resemblance.

Business Cards — Designed within the visual identity system.

SEO Keyword List — Researched, created, and implemented into website